

Bristol City Council

Minutes of the Transport & Connectivity Policy Committee



19 March 2026 at 5.00 pm

Members Present:-

Councillors: Ed Plowden (Chair), Graham Morris (Vice-Chair), Rob Bryher, Nicholas Coombes, Emma Edwards, Tom Renhard, Tim Rippington, Kaz Self and David Wilcox

Officers in Attendance:-

John Smith (Executive Director: Growth & Regeneration), Patsy Mellor (Director, Management of Place) and Adam Crowther (Head of City Transport)

1 Welcome, Introductions and Safety Information

The Chair welcomed all attendees to the meeting and explained the emergency evacuation procedure. The Chair asked the Committee members to introduce themselves

2 Apologies for Absence and Substitutions

There were no apologies

3 Declarations of Interest

There were none.

4 Minutes of the Previous Meeting

The minutes of the previous meeting were agreed as accurate.



5 Chair's Announcements

The Chair provided the following updates:

- Delegated Officer Decision Notices have now been published on the Council's website.
- Councillor Bryher, Chair of the Parking Kerbside Strategy Task and Finish Group, updated the Committee on the Group's ongoing work. He confirmed that the next phase will involve drafting the strategy, with a report expected to be brought to the Committee in the autumn.

6 Public Forum

The Committee noted that the following public forum had been received.

Public Petitions

There were no public petitions presented to the Committee at this meeting.

Public Statements

36 statements were received and noted as follows:

Ref No	Name	Title
01	Jon Nicholls	Objections to RPS changes
02	Joseph Thomas	Support safety for children and a better city.
03	Judith Worthington	Against South Bristol liveable neighbourhood on grounds of safety to cyclists and pedestrians
04	Jacqueline Perkins	Opposition to SBLN
05	Alexandra Veitch	Please provide a viable alternative to car travel
06	Zoe Mack	SBLN - consultation
07	Kelly Smallcombe	Is the South Bristol Liveable Neighbourhood Optimised for the "Average Traveller" at the Expense of Women?
08	Haydn Gill	Supporting safer streets for all
09	Anna Haydock-Wilson	20MPH for Cumberland Road, Hotwell Road and Merchants Road
10	Suzanne Audrey, Chair of TRESA	Support for 20mph speed limits
11	Ian Pond - Bristol Cycling Campaign	Bristol Cycling Campaign supports the 20mph Review (Item 8)
12	Rose Gray	Support reduction of 20mph on Hotwell Rd &



		Merchants Rd
13	Carol Fox	EBLN
14	Sarah Halligan	Can adjoining sections of Brunel Way/HotwellsRd be reduced from 40mph to 30mph to support the proposed 20mph limit on hotwells rdh
15	Felicity Burdett	Support of speed reduction to Merchants Road and Cumberland Basin Road
16	Melissa Topping	EBLN Statement on the Systematic Exclusion and Rights of Access for Disabled Residents
17	Satyen Joshi	SBLN - EMERGING THEMES IN SOUTHVILLE
18	Lynda Keeyes	South Bristol Livable Neighbourhood proposals and general transport plans
19	Katherine Bridget Grant	20 MPH for Hotwell road
20	Matt Edwards	Support for Hotwells Road Speed Reduction
21	Elise Cole	Statement in Support of 20mph Speed Limit Proposals – Hotwells and Harbourside
22	Elizabeth Forrester	Parent's statement in support of proposal to reduce speed limit to 20mph on Hotwells rd and surrounding areas
23	Jule Mulder	Speed reduction Hotwell Road
24	Councillor Patrick McAllister	Support for 20mph Roads in Hotwells & Harbourside
25	Professor Albert Sanchez-Graells	Strong support for reduction to 20mph around Hotwells Primary School
26	Mark James	Speed Restriction surrounding Hotwells school
27	David Redgewell	Transport Issues
28	Brendon Taylor	Bus service cuts in Stapleton, stakeholders in villages of Frenchay, Stapleton and Eastville with NHS farm facilities Burden Neurological hospital
29	Rosa Kell	Bus Services
30	Amber Eastman	A healthy city - The LTN paradox
31	Councillor Serena Ralston	Agenda item 8. 20 mph review Cllr Serena Ralston, Clifton Down: Statement: 'Make our roads safer'
32	Elizabeth Newton	South Bristol Liveable Neighbourhood
33	Roger Gimson, Bristol Walking Alliance	Road Safety and 20mph Review
34	Jesse Zyla	90 Faded Signs around St Lukes Road
35	Megs Smith	Bristol's Liveable Neighbourhood Schemes
36	Caroline Dunn	You have WASTED OUR MONEY.



Statements 6, 10, 24, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, and 35 were presented to the Committee.

Public Forum Questions

A total of 80 questions were received as follows:

Ref No	Name	Title
01, 02 & 03	Mr Shaban Ali	01 – EBLN Monitoring Report Q1 02 – EBLN Monitoring Report Q2 03 – EBLN Monitoring Report Q3
04, 05 & 06	Jan Ratcliffe	04 – Residential sacrifice streets are unfair on those residents 05 – Community street parties and roads selected for main routes 06 - What steps are being planned for worst case scenarios congestion
07	Alec Jennings	Road Freedom
08, 09 & 10	Catherine Mellor	08 – SBLN Revised proposals to include APNR cameras 09 – SBLN use of APNR cameras 10 - Use of APNR cameras in SBLN
11	Richard Newnham	SBLN co-design
12, 13 & 14	Judith Worthington	12 – Public information relating to reason traffic in North Street increasing 13 – What reassurances and guarantees are there that there will be no increase in response times for emergency services to all areas of Southville if the SBLN is introduced 14 - Why should residents have to pay for something they do not need or want
15, 16 & 17	Zoe Mack	15 – Surveying Southville 16 – Future consultation 17 - Pollution monitor
18, 19 & 20	Evy Loizou	18 - EBLN Monitoring Report Misleading Data 19 - EBLN impact data on local businesses SBLN proposals: impact data on lower-income residents
21, 22 & 23	Mark Smallcombe	21 - Winners and Losers – SBLN 22 - Why does the SBLN (designed by men) fail to account for primary women's problems? 23 – Did the council hold any data prior to the SBLN plans or was it just on feelings and filling someone's



		CV?
24, 25 & 26	Kelly Smallcombe	24 - When Transport Policy Optimises for the Average, Who Gets Left Behind? Women and the SBLN 25 - Evidence-Led Policy or Policy-Led Evidence? 26 – Cherry Picking Data - a BCC Expertise
27, 28 & 29	James Alexander	27 - Failures of the Transport Dept 28 - Failures of the Freedom of Information Dept 29 – Failures of the Complaints Dept
30, 31 & 32	Alison Bramall	30 – Traffic counters 31 – SBLN access 32 - Modal filters/works at Bedminster Bridge roundabout
33a, 33b & 33c	Matt Sanders	Inconsistent Bus Gate Signage
34	Dan Ackroyd	Data regarding traffic flow
35	Megs Smith	Council coercion or democracy?
36,37 & 38	David Redgewell	Transport and connectivity committee 19th March 2026
39, 40 & 41	Elizabeth Newton	39- SBLN Consultation Data Query? 40 & 41- SBLN - post consultation survey
42,43 & 44	SATYEN JOSHI	42- SBLN - CO DESIGN PHASE 43- SBLN - EXPENDITURE TO DATE AND HOW £1.32 MILLION EXTRA FUNDING IS INTENDED TO BE SPENT 44- LTNs: BENEFITS TO COST RATIO
45,46 & 47	Lynda Keeys	45- Air Quality Monitoring and CAZ 46- South Bristol Liveable Neighbourhood (SBLN) 47- SBLN
48 & 49	Satwant Phull	48 & 49- EBLN
50, 51 & 52	Rosa Kell	Transport connectivity committee 19th March 2026
53, 54 & 55	Helen Hughes	53 & 54- Current EBLN consultations 55- Current EBLN TRO consultation
56, 57 & 58	Anne Dockery	56- LTN : Air Quality and Carbon 57- Evidence & Data Transparency SBLN 58-SBLN
59	Abi Salinger	59- SBLN: The Gender Divide/Low Income Households and Employment
60,61, & 62	Teri Bramah	60- Can Bcc divulge the level of support for vs opposition against the SBLN, in the recent Autumn



		25 consultation survey? And if not now, then when? 61- SBLN and Playing Out, annual (frequent) street party events 62- Publishing of Data gathered and used to assess specific low-income household vehicle needs in planning of SBLN
63	Ian Pond	63- Cycling Provision alongside the A4018 on the Bristol Downs
64, 65 & 66	Brendan Taylor	Cabinet meeting 18th March 2026
67 & 68	Susan Marshall	67- SBLN survey of road use 68- Length of journeys in Southville before and after SBLN imposition
69	Dr Tony Hoare	Update on the introduction of parking charges to ten currently free-to-use car parks
70, 71 & 72	Robert Harakis	76 – Which Traffic Surveys are relevant? 77 – How was the Data compiled? 78 - Or is there NO relevant traffic data...?
73	Pippa Nesbit	Public Forum — Order of Receipt
74 & 75	Councillor Richard Eddy	20mph Review
76, 77 & 78	Caroline Dunn	73 – fix my street frequently doesn't work or doesn't achieve anything. 74 – Denmark Street Access Hippodrome 75 – Denmark Street Access Hippodrome

Those who attended the meeting were invited to ask up to two supplementary questions. The following responses were given:

Q15, 16 & 17 – Zoe Mack

Officers confirmed that teams had visited the area to carry out the necessary assessments and surveys prior to developing the proposed schemes. The cost information relating to the design work was not available at the meeting. Officers advised that this information would be shared, subject to commercial sensitivity considerations. **ACTION: Officers to provide cost information to the participant in writing.**

Q33a, 33b & 33c – Matt Sanders

Officers confirmed that they had reviewed Mr Sanders' report and reiterated that the signage at the Cumberland Bus Gate has been assessed as compliant. Officers advised that they would consider the proposals raised in the report; however, any potential changes to signage or street furniture would need to be evaluated in the context of ensuring the appropriate use of public funds, given that the Bus Gate is already deemed compliant.

Q34 – Dan Ackroyd



Officers confirmed that the data provided was sourced from TomTom Move, which uses GPS information from private cars. The dataset primarily illustrates vehicle movements originating from Park Street, but it does not include sufficient detail to distinguish taxi journeys from other private car trips.

Q35 – Megs Smith

The Chair disagreed with the suggestion that residents' comments would not be taken into account when reaching a decision.

Q53, 54 & 55 – Helen Hughes

Officers confirmed that the intention of Liveable Neighbourhood schemes is to encourage a shift towards more trips being made by sustainable transport modes. The schemes do not prevent anyone from making car journeys they previously undertook. Officers also explained that the use of Automatic Number Plate Recognition (ANPR) cameras for moving traffic enforcement is one option that could improve monitoring, particularly in locations where maintaining quicker and easier access for emergency vehicles is important, compared with physical point-closure bollards.

Q64, 65 & 66 – Brendan Taylor

Officers confirmed that funding available to support bus services is limited, while costs increase and demand is high. As a result, difficult decisions are required, and an assessment has been undertaken to evaluate the benefits of different services, considering factors such as passenger usage and the availability of alternative routes nearby. Officers added that the Council will continue to work with the Combined Authority on options for bus reform. They also noted that emergency bus contracts currently in place provide additional time to review these services and assess their deliverable benefits.

Q50, 51 & 52 – Rosa Kell

Officers confirmed that information on uncollectable debt arising from CAZ infringements had been reported to the Strategy & Resources Policy Committee. **ACTION: A link to the report would be circulated to the participant.**

7 Road Safety Task and Finish Group - closure report

The Committee received a non key decision update report outlining the key outcomes of the Road Safety Task and Finish Group.

The Chair of the Group, Councillor Wilcox and the Road Safety Group Manager introduced the report. During discussion, Members raised the following points:

- The Regional Road Safety Partnership is in the process of finalising its terms of reference and is working collaboratively with local authorities across the region to agree shared priorities.
- Ongoing engagement is taking place with the stakeholders listed in the report, as well as additional groups, to further develop the work and the emerging strategy.



- Members noted that the ambitious targets set out in the report will require difficult decisions and clear, tangible actions to ensure progress in the desired direction and timeframes.
- Members emphasised the importance of understanding public perceptions of safety at different locations. They highlighted the need for this to be visualised within the strategy alongside collision data, noting that the 'feeling of safety' is subjective and requires further data and understanding within this data led strategy.
- It was noted that the Government has indicated an intention to bring forward legislation relating to micromobility, although no definitive timeframe has yet been provided.
- The concept of gender budgeting would need further exploration and explanation within the context of the Road Safety Strategy.
- Additional stakeholder feedback will be sought from motorcyclists; relevant contacts have been identified and engagement is planned over the coming weeks.

Following the discussion;

The Committee for Transport and Connectivity noted the information provided in the closure report (Appendix A) which will inform the drafting of a road safety strategy. The strategy will be brought to Transport and Connectivity Committee in due course for approval.

8 20 mph Review

The Committee considered a report that updated the Committee on the 20mph Review, including an evidence review and technical assessment. The report sought approval to launch a six-week public engagement on the outcomes of that technical assessment which would invite the public and further stakeholder and councillor input on the proposals to introduce a 20mph speed limit on 97 roads identified in the technical assessment.

This was a key decision report as it impacts 2 or more wards.

The Head of City Transport introduced and outlined the report.

Following Members clarification on elements of the report, officers confirmed the following points:

- A comprehensive consultation process is planned, with ongoing engagement with Councillors. Officers will work with the Chair to ensure all issues are fully captured and explored.
- Officers hope to receive detailed feedback from the bus companies to better understand how lower speed limits in specific locations may affect bus journey times. While operators have previously raised broader concerns about the concept of reduced speed limits, officers now anticipate evidence-based, locality-specific feedback on journey time impacts as part of the consultation.



- The proposals relate to approximately 59 miles of road – around 5% of the overall network – yet these routes account for 30% of serious and fatal casualties, reflecting their high use by pedestrians, cyclists and motor vehicles. Officers noted that reducing vehicle speeds would help more people feel comfortable walking and cycling.
- The proposal to delegate the decision to the Executive Director, Growth and Regeneration in consultation with the Chair, was intended to expedite the process which otherwise would mean returning to Committee in September. Committee Members asked officers to explore whether Committee dates could be moved to enable an earlier decision.
- The police have been a key stakeholder throughout the development of the proposals and are likely to comment on individual road proposals. Officers note that the case for 20mph limits had evolved significantly since last proposed in 2014, further work could be supported by the developing work of the Regional Road Safety Partnership.
- The greatest safety benefits from adopting 20mph limits would arise on busier/faster residential main roads, which act as key cycling and walking corridors that currently lack other significant planned safety improvements.
- Members asked to receive the results of the public consultation and noted that the level of public support will not be known until the consultation is undertaken. Members expressed the view that, if consideration of the consultation outcomes requires a political decision, then the matter should return to Committee.
- The consultation will record where respondents live in relation to the roads they comment on, so this information can form part of the evaluation.
- The 20mph website has been updated ahead of the consultation to assist in providing information to the public. Officers will work with the Communications Team on a planned comms campaign.

ACTION: Briefing on comms activities to be sent to T&C Councillors.

Following the discussion, report recommendation 1 was noted.

Councillor Plowden moved report recommendation 2 and it was seconded by Councillor Wilcox.

On being put to the vote, recommendation 2 was CARRIED unanimously.

Councillor Plowden moved report recommendation 3 and it was seconded by Councillor Wilcox.

On being put to the vote, recommendation 3 FELL (2 voting for, 7 voting against)

It was APPROVED that;

That the Committee for Transport and Connectivity:

- 1. Noted the outcomes of the review of evidence and best practice and the technical road by-road assessment outlined in Appendix A.**
- 2. Approved launching a six-week public engagement on the outcomes of that technical assessment.**



Recommendation 3 was not approved:

3. Authorise the Executive Director for Growth & Regeneration, in consultation with the Chair of Transport and Connectivity Committee, to consider the outcomes of the public engagement and, informed by this, make a delegated decision on which of the proposals should or should not proceed to the statutory Traffic Regulation Order (TRO) process, which includes further statutory consultation.

9 Incentive Funding

The Committee considered a report that sought approval to accept and spend the proposed Incentive funding allocation from West of England Mayoral Combined Authority (MCA) as part of the City Region Sustainable Transport Settlement (CRSTS).

This was a key decision report as it related to a decision involving over £500k and affected 2 or more wards.

The Director, Management of Place introduced the report and provided an overview of the funding. The funding was awarded in 2024 as Incentive Funding. Following Bristol City Council's successful demonstration of compliance with best practice in preventative highways maintenance techniques the funding can now be drawn down. The funding has been, and will continue to be, used to deliver highways maintenance schemes drawn from the priority list of roads requiring intervention, in line with recognised best-practice standards.

It was clarified that page 2 of the report should read "inspecting every road and footway every year. Over 1200km of roads and 2500km of footways."

Members emphasised the importance of timely intervention and effective maintenance to avoid the need for repeat visits and additional remedial work.

The report recommendations were moved by Councillor Plowden and seconded by Councillor Renhard.

On being put to the vote the recommendations were CARRIED (unanimously).

That the Committee for Transport and Connectivity:

1. Noted the proposed indicative funding allocations of £2,467,388 Incentive funds

2. Authorised the Executive Director Growth and Regeneration, in consultation with the Chair of Transport and Connectivity Committee, to take all steps required to accept and spend up to of £2,467,388 of Incentive funds.



3. Authorised the Executive Director Growth and Regeneration, in consultation with the Chair of Transport and Connectivity Committee to take all steps necessary to procure and award any contracts (including any contracts over the key decision threshold) necessary to deliver the works associated with this funding.

4. Authorised the Executive Director Growth and Regeneration, in consultation with the Chair of Transport and Connectivity Committee to make reasonable changes to the programme of works to ensure delivery of the programme, in accordance with the Council's scheme of financial delegations.

10 Workplace Parking Levy Update report

The Committee received a report for information updating the committee on progress with the Workplace Parking Levy Outline Business Case (OBC) and to outline progress on key project milestones.

The Head of City Transport introduced the report. During discussion, Members raised the following points:

- The reduced project timeline was noted, following delays that had impacted earlier stages of the work. Officers confirmed that the consultants had agreed to the revised schedule.
- Due to a relatively low number of responses received from businesses, additional data collection took place via door-to-door engagement. The data gathered will feed into modelling and forecasting to help shape potential scheme options for future Committee consideration.
- Officers confirmed that the information being sought includes the the number of parking spaces businesses hold, their frequency of use, and business views on how revenue generated should be reinvested within the city.
- Members highlighted the potential impacts on workers, including any risk to jobs or business relocation. They stressed that any proposed exemptions or boundary changes would need to be communicated early, particularly regarding the potential impact on schools.
- It was suggested that the next update report should include further consideration of the IT implications. Although less substantial than those associated with the Clean Air Zone (CAZ), some processing requirements must be expected.
- Members noted that the Transport Infrastructure Plan (formerly known as the Movement Plan) would play an important role in the context of the scheme.
- Members emphasised the importance of developing the Investment Strategy for Workplace Parking Levy revenue, recognising it as a crucial part of the project. They requested cross-party engagement in shaping the Investment Strategy, with the aim of securing broad political support for how any revenue would be deployed, and clarity of the final proposals.

Following the discussion;

The Committee for Transport and Connectivity noted this update report.



11 Policy Committee Work Programme Setting - Outcome Report

The Committee received a report for information presenting the outcomes of the six monthly work programme setting workshop held on 29 January 2026 with particular focus on the coming 2026-2027 municipal year.

The Policy Committee Officer introduced the report. In discussion, the following points were clarified:

- In relation to the **Cohesive Street Furniture Licensing Policy**, it was confirmed that the Chairs of the Public Health & Communities Policy Committee, the Licensing Committee, and the Economy & Skills Policy Committee would be invited to the relevant T&C Policy Committee Chairs Briefing (PCCB) for further discussion.
- Regarding the **roll out Sheffield Stands to more communities** topic, a paper would be presented to the T&C PCCB outlining the planned process and timeline, which can then be communicated to Members.
- Concerning the **Feasibility Study for establishing a municipal bus company**, officers confirmed that the related work is currently being undertaken by the Mayoral Combined Authority (MCA). It was noted that Bristol City Council should await the outcome of that work before considering its own position.
- On **value-for-money roadworks**, there had been a Member request for an initial briefing about how maintenance is prioritised and delivered, followed by a further briefing session regarding how officers assess new techniques and initiate innovative solutions. **(ACTION: PCO to arrange Members' briefing sessions.)**
- The 'Fix My Street' tool is due for procurement renewal within the next 1–2 years. The Chair suggested evaluation takes place to gather the views of Councillors and alongside, consider improvements to communication processes.
- The suggestion regarding **Equalities: Women in Transport / a digital reporting mechanism for sexual harassment on public transport** was welcomed.

Following the discussion,

The Committee for Transport and Connectivity noted the work programme update.

Meeting ended at 7.30 pm

CHAIR _____

